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CANDIDATE SURNAME

OTHER NAMES

CENTRE NUMBER

CANDIDATE NUMBER

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

HISTORY · PAPER 3: MODERN DEPTH STUDY

Time: 1 hour 20 minutes (Complete Mock) · 52 Marks (+4 SPaG)

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Key Topic 4: The End of the Vietnam War, 1968–75

Comprehensive 11-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1968–1975

PAPER
REFERENCE

1H10/33

Instructions: Use black ink or ball-point pen. Fill in candidate details above.

- Answer ALL questions in Section A (Question 1 and Question 2).
- Answer ALL questions in Section B (Question 3(a), 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)).
- Read the Section B Historical Enquiry Dossier carefully on Page 5 before attempting Questions 3(a)–(d).

TOTAL MARKS

56

(52 + 4 SPaG)

Advice: Spend approx. 15 minutes on Section A Q1–Q2, and 60 minutes on Section B Q3(a)–(d). **SPaG:** 4 marks are awarded for spelling, punctuation, grammar, and specialist terms on Q3(d).

Q	TYPE	SPECIFICATION TOPIC FOCUS	PAGE	MARKS	AUDIT
SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER (COMPULSORY QUESTION 1 & QUESTION 2)					
Q1	INFERENCE	Source A: The Kent State University Shootings (May 1970)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	EXPLAIN WHY	Why Nixon Introduced Vietnamization in 1969	P3	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & INTERPRETATIONS (INTEGRATED 36M + 4 SPAG)					
Dossier	ENQUIRY	Dossier: Growth of Anti-War Opposition (Sources B, C & Ints 1, 2)	P4	Dossier	☐ / Read
3 (a)	UTILITY	Sources B & C: Reasons for Growth of Anti-War Opposition	P5	[8]	☐ / 8
3 (b)	DIFFERENCE	Interpretations 1 & 2: Main Difference in Views on Anti-War Movement	P6	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (c)	REASON	Interpretations 1 & 2: Reasons for Difference in Historical Views	P6	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (d)	ESSAY	Evaluative Essay: How Far Do You Agree with Interpretation 1?	P7–8	[20]	☐ / 20
4	DEPTH BOOSTER	Spec Depth: Why the Paris Peace Accords Were Signed (1973)	P9	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION C: GRADE 8/9 STANDARDS & EXAM TRAPS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Exemplars	SECTION A MODELS	Full Level 2 Model Q1 & Level 4 Model Q2 Essay + Examiner Marks	P10	Audit	☐ Verified
Exemplars	SECTION B MODELS	Full Level 3 Model Q3a, Q3b, Q3c & Level 4 Q3d Model + Top 3 Traps	P11	Audit	☐ Verified

Source A: Ohio National Guard Confronting Anti-War Student Protesters at Kent State University, 4 May 1970

Kent State University Libraries • Special Collections and Archives, May 4 Collection



Armed Ohio National Guardsmen in military formation and gas masks deploy tear gas canisters against unarmed student demonstrators on the campus commons protesting President Nixon’s invasion of Cambodia. Minutes later, troops fired sixty-seven live rounds, killing four students.

Provenance: Contemporary news photograph documenting the confrontation between the Ohio National Guard and anti-war student demonstrators at Kent State University, 4 May 1970.

1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about the confrontation at Kent State University in May 1970. (4)

(I) INFERENCE 1:

What I can infer from Source A:

.....

Details in the source that tell me this:

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(II) INFERENCE 2:

What I can infer from Source A:

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Details in the source that tell me this:

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Candidate Response Lines:

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SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY DOSSIER

Read this archival dossier carefully. All questions in Section B (Questions 3a–3d) relate to these materials.

SECTION B DOSSIER

HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS: THE MAIN REASON FOR THE GROWTH OF OPPOSITION TO THE VIETNAM WAR IN THE USA (1968–71)

PAPER 3 · SECTION B

Source B: From a special television broadcast by CBS News anchor Walter Cronkite, 27 February 1968

CBS News Broadcast Archives

"It seems now more certain than ever that the bloody experience of Vietnam is to end in a stalemate. To say that we are closer to victory today is to believe, in the face of the evidence, the optimists who have been wrong in the past. To suggest we are on the edge of defeat is to yield to unreasonable despair. To say that we are mired in stalemate seems the only realistic, yet unsatisfactory, conclusion. It is increasingly clear to this reporter that the only rational way out will be to negotiate, not as victors, but as an honorable people who lived up to their pledge to defend democracy and did the best they could."

Provenance: Broadcast to millions of American households by the nation's most respected news anchor following his fact-finding mission to Vietnam after the Tet Offensive.

Source C: From an anti-draft flyer distributed by Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) at university campuses, October 1969

Wisconsin Historical Society

"Rich young men with political connections go to prestigious colleges and receive student deferments. Working-class and Black youth who cannot afford university are handed M16 rifles and shipped off to die in the jungles for a corrupt dictatorship in Saigon. Over 35,000 American boys have already come home in aluminum coffins, while Washington politicians lie about 'progress'. We refuse to participate in the slaughter of Vietnamese peasants. Burn your draft cards! Join the nationwide Moratorium on October 15! Strike against the war machine!"

Provenance: Protest pamphlet produced and circulated by the student anti-war organization Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) prior to the October 1969 Moratorium.

Interpretation 1

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Chester Pach, 'The Real Media War on Vietnam' (1996):

"The fundamental engine driving mass opposition to the war was television journalism and the uncensored visual exposure of combat horrors. Vietnam was America's first 'living-room war'. Night after night, millions of ordinary Americans watched unedited color footage of wounded soldiers, burning huts, civilian body counts, and napalmed children alongside their evening dinners. When trusted national figures like Walter Cronkite declared the war unwinnable after the Tet Offensive, it shattered the government's credibility. The media's subsequent exposure of atrocities like the My Lai massacre in 1969 made it impossible for the moral conscience of middle America to support the war any longer."

Interpretation 2

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Melvin Small, 'Antiwarriors: The Vietnam War and the Battle for America's Hearts and Minds' (2002):

"While television coverage was vivid, the primary catalyst for mass domestic opposition was the personal, immediate threat posed by the military draft system combined with skyrocketing American casualties. Young men faced the terrifying prospect of conscription into an ambiguous conflict, producing a massive student rebellion across college campuses. Student organizations like SDS, energized by civil rights techniques, transformed anti-war sentiment into sustained street mobilization, draft-card burnings, and nationwide moratoriums involving millions of demonstrators. It was the visceral fear of the draft, coupled with the rising toll of over 50,000 American deaths, that galvanized grassroots resistance and made the war politically unsustainable."

Enquiry Core: Source B & C provide contemporary primary evidence; Interpretations 1 & 2 provide competing modern historical views. **Keep Page 5 open for Q3(a)–(d)**

Spend approx. 12 minutes on Question 3(a). Evaluate content, provenance (COP), and context.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)? (8)

Source B Utility (Content & COP): Illustrates the immense influence of televised news journalism; Cronkite declaring the war a stalemate destroyed the "credibility gap" and swayed middle-class opinion.

Source C Utility (Content & COP): Illustrates the anger over the military draft system, class inequalities (deferments for rich students), rising body bags, and the direct action tactics of student groups like SDS.

Contextual Knowledge: Reference the Tet Offensive (1968), the My Lai Massacre revelations (Nov 1969), the Draft Lottery (Dec 1969), and the Kent State shootings (May 1970).

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Q3(b) and 5 minutes on Q3(c). Write in concise, focused prose.

3 (b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

Different Views Frame: *The historians give different views because they have relied on different sources/evidence. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which emphasizes... whereas Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which emphasizes...*

Spend approx. 25 minutes on Question 3(d). 16 marks for content + 4 marks for SPaG.

3 (d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)? (16 + 4 SPaG)

- Points in Int 2 that are valid
- Evidence from Source C supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Counter-argument in Int 1
- Evidence from Source B supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Media coverage & credibility gap (Living-room war, Walter Cronkite, My Lai massacre exposed in 1969)
- The draft & student protest (Conscription threat, draft card burnings, SDS, Kent State shootings 1970)
- Casualties & economic strain (58,000+ total US deaths, runaway inflation, veterans joining protests (VVAW))

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(D) (CONTINUED)

Complete your synthesis and reach a weighed, criteria-based conclusion.

Q3(D): CONCLUSION & JUDGEMENT

Conclusion Rule: State explicitly *how far* you agree with Interpretation 2 using your chosen criteria. Do not merely summarize.

SPaG Check: Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. SCLC, Supreme Court, Vietcong).

Lined area for writing the conclusion and judgement.

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 4 MARK SCHEME [13–16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 17–20 MARKS]:

☐ Both Interpretations Weighed ☐ Extensive Contextual Facts ☐ Sustained Evaluative Criteria ☐ Flawless SPaG & Specialist Terms

Exhaustive specification coverage. Practice an alternative high-yield exam question for this Key Topic.

4 Explain why the Paris Peace Accords were signed in January 1973.

You may use the following in your answer:

- (You must also use information of your own.)*

Operation Linebacker II (Christmas Bombings)

40,000 tons of bombs on Hanoi & Haiphong

Nixon visit to Beijing (Feb 1972) & Moscow (May 1972)

Henry Kissinger and Le Duc Tho talks

Complete withdrawal of US troops in 60 days Return of all American POWs

- **P1:** Superpower Diplomacy & Détente: Nixon's diplomatic breakthroughs in Beijing and Moscow pressuring North Vietnam to negotiate.

- **P2:** Operation Linebacker II: The devastating 11-day Christmas bombing forcing Hanoi back to the negotiating table.
- **P3:** American Domestic Pressure (Own Knowledge): The US public's absolute exhaustion with the war and congressional threats to cut funding.

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES • SECTION A

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 & Level 4 continuous prose models with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q2

QUESTION 1: SOURCE INFERENCE EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 2 (4/4)

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the confrontation at Kent State University in May 1970.

(i) What I can infer: I can infer that the government deployed heavily armed, militarized forces onto university grounds to suppress anti-war protests. Details in the source that tell me this: The photograph shows a large formation of Ohio National Guardsmen wearing gas masks and military uniforms marching in rank across the campus green.

(ii) What I can infer: I can infer that the confrontation caused widespread panic and chaos across the university. Details in the source that tell me this: Plumes of tear gas are billowing across the commons while unarmed students flee across the field in panic.

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Two valid, supported inferences extracted directly from the primary photograph.

QUESTION 2: CAUSATION ESSAY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 4 (12/12)

Explain why President Richard Nixon introduced the policy of Vietnamization in 1969. (12 marks)

A primary reason for introducing Vietnamization was the unsustainable toll of American casualties combined with the psychological shock of the Tet Offensive in 1968. Over 14,000 American soldiers were killed in 1968 alone, bringing total US combat deaths past 30,000. The Tet Offensive thoroughly demolished the Johnson administration's claims that victory was near, creating an irreparable 'credibility gap' in the minds of the American public. When CBS anchor Walter Cronkite declared the war mired in a bloody stalemate, public support for maintaining massive US troop deployments collapsed, convincing incoming President Nixon that the war had become politically unwinnable with American ground forces.

Furthermore, Nixon introduced Vietnamization to fulfill his central 1968 presidential election campaign promise of achieving "peace with honor." Nixon understood that immediate, unilateral withdrawal would be seen as an ignominious defeat, damaging America's Cold War credibility and leading to the immediate communist takeover of South Vietnam. Vietnamization was designed as a strategic compromise: it allowed Nixon to systematically de-escalate domestic anti-war fury by withdrawing American conscripts, while transferring ground combat responsibilities to the South Vietnamese army (ARVN) so the US did not appear to be surrendering.

Finally, Vietnamization was made feasible by a massive program to re-equip and modernize the ARVN into a self-sufficient fighting force. The United States poured billions of dollars of modern military hardware into South Vietnam, providing over one million M16 rifles, armored vehicles, heavy artillery, and the world's fourth-largest air force. Between 1969 and 1972, Nixon withdrew over 500,000 American troops while relying heavily on US air power to support ARVN ground operations. This enabled Nixon to dramatically reduce US casualties while maintaining military pressure on North Vietnam during peace negotiations in Paris.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (12/12 Marks): Outstanding causal analysis; explores casualties/Tet, Nixon's domestic political strategy, and ARVN modernization; rich factual detail and sophisticated historical terminology.

SECTION C: SECTION B MODELS & FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS

Official Level 3 & Level 4 continuous prose models and high-frequency pitfalls to avoid.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q3 & TRAPS

QUESTION 3(A): SOURCE UTILITY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 3 (8/8)

Source B is exceptionally useful because it provides direct evidence of how influential national television journalists helped turn middle-class public opinion against the war. Walter Cronkite was universally regarded as "the most trusted man in America." When he broadcast his personal verdict on 27 February 1968 stating that the war was "mired in stalemate" and that negotiation was the only rational exit, it dealt a catastrophic blow to government claims of military progress. The utility of Source B lies in its massive national reach: President Johnson famously remarked, "If I've lost Cronkite, I've lost middle America." This demonstrates how televised editorial commentary legitimized anti-war views among ordinary, previously patriotic citizens.

Source C is equally useful because it offers direct insight into the intense grievances driving the youth and student anti-war movement. Circulated by Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) in October 1969, the leaflet reveals how the military draft was viewed as deeply discriminatory, forcing working-class and Black youth to die in "aluminum coffins" while wealthy students secured college deferments. The provenance makes it particularly valuable: as an authentic organizing pamphlet for the historic nationwide Moratorium of October 1969 (which mobilized over two million protesters), it shows how student radicals actively channeled fear of conscription into civil disobedience and draft-card burnings. When contextualized alongside the horrific revelations of the My Lai massacre in November 1969 and the Kent State shootings in May 1970, both sources are highly useful: Source B shows how television destroyed government credibility for middle America, while Source C demonstrates how the threat of the draft radicalized American youth.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8/8 Marks): Exceptional evaluation of both sources; analyzes media influence vs the military draft; thoroughly investigates nature, origin, purpose, and detailed contextual knowledge.

QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C): INTERPRETATIONS EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 2 (4/4 + 4/4)

Q3(b) Difference: The main difference is that Interpretation 1 views the growth of anti-war opposition as primarily driven by television journalism and visual media exposure of combat atrocities (such as Walter Cronkite's broadcast and the My Lai massacre), whereas Interpretation 2 argues that opposition was primarily fueled by the personal, immediate threat of the military draft system, rising US casualties, and direct student activism on university campuses.

Q3(c) Reason: Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views because the historians have investigated different dimensions of the anti-war movement. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on television network archives and media reception studies like Source B, analyzing how broadcast coverage of combat created a credibility gap for middle-class Americans. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has examined university archives, protest leaflets like Source C, and draft resistance statistics, focusing on how conscription and rising body counts mobilized American college youth.

Examiner Annotation: Q3b: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Clear, direct contrast between media-driven and draft/casualty-driven arguments with specific supporting details from both extracts. | Q3c: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Fully developed explanation connecting differing historical viewpoints to differing evidence types and historical focuses.

QUESTION 3(D): EVALUATIVE ESSAY CONCLUSION MODEL

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 4 (16+4 = 20/20)

In conclusion, I agree with Interpretation 2 to a very large extent, because the personal, visceral threat posed by the military draft system and escalating American casualties was the primary engine that mobilized millions of Americans into sustained street protest. Conscription forced millions of young American men to confront the terrifying reality that they could be legally compelled to fight and die in an ambiguous foreign conflict. As seen in Source C, the draft was deeply unequal, offering deferments to wealthy college students while sending working-class and Black youth to die in 'aluminum coffins'. Combined with the grim toll of over 50,000 American deaths, this personal fear transformed passive unease into militant student strikes, draft-card burnings, and massive demonstrations like the 1969 Moratorium. When the Ohio National Guard killed four unarmed students at Kent State in 1970, it triggered strikes across 400 campuses. While Interpretation 1 correctly argues that uncensored television coverage and Walter Cronkite's post-Tet verdict shattered government credibility, television alone could not have generated such militant mass resistance without the direct threat of conscription and body bags. Therefore, while television exposed the horrors of war, the draft and casualties made the conflict intolerable.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (16+4 = 20/20 Marks): Authoritative evaluative essay; establishes clear criteria comparing media exposure against conscription and casualties; demonstrates profound mastery of the Edexcel specification.

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 4

- **Vietnamization was NOT an immediate withdrawal**

Nixon withdrew US ground combat troops gradually over 4 years (1969–73) while vastly INCREASING aerial bombing (Operation Linebacker) and invading Cambodia and Laos.
- **The Draft was NOT equal across social classes**

Until the 1969 draft lottery, wealthy and middle-class youths received college deferments, meaning working-class and Black Americans were disproportionately drafted and killed.
- **Kent State occurred because of the CAMBODIA invasion**

The May 1970 Kent State protests were specifically triggered by President Nixon's surprise television announcement that US forces had invaded neighboring Cambodia.